

STAGE ONE • SELF-AWARENESS & CAREER CLARITY

FIRSTS

FAQ

Anticipated participant questions and suggested facilitator responses

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

BY AYOMIDE AYENI

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Stage One • Self-Awareness & Career Clarity

PURPOSE

These are the questions that come up most often across cohorts of Stage One, with a suggested facilitator response for each. Use these as a starting point, not a rigid script — the goal is a genuine, direct answer, not a rehearsed one.

Frequently Asked Questions

Q1. What if I don't know my target industry or role yet?

A: That's completely normal at this stage, and honestly the point of Stage One. Use your best current guess for Session 2's research — the goal is practicing the research process, not landing on a final answer. Many participants' targets shift after doing the research.

Q2. Do I have to share my answers with the group?

A: Some activities include an explicitly opt-in share (especially Weakness Awareness in FIRST 06). Anything not explicitly framed as opt-in is a genuine ask to participate, but you're always welcome to keep specific personal details private while still contributing to the group activity's format.

Q3. What if my personality assessment result doesn't feel accurate?

A: That's useful information, not a failure of the exercise. Bring that mismatch to the discussion — sometimes it reveals a genuine blind spot, and sometimes it reveals the assessment caught you on an atypical day. Either way, it's worth exploring rather than dismissing.

Q4. I'm switching careers entirely — does this still apply to me?

A: Yes, and arguably even more directly. The FIRSTS in this stage are about understanding yourself and the market, not about a specific industry. A career switcher doing this work honestly often ends up with more clarity than someone who's never questioned their original path.

Q5. What if two of my core values seem to conflict with each other?

A: That's genuinely common and worth sitting with rather than resolving artificially. Bring it to FIRST 12 (Career SWOT) or a 1:1 with your facilitator — real values tension (e.g., ambition vs. work-life balance) often becomes a genuine, ongoing decision filter rather than something to solve once.

Q6. How long should the Work Style and Learning Style tracking (FIRSTS 15 and 17) actually take each day?

A: A few minutes. It's meant to be a quick daily note, not a big journaling project — one or two sentences at the end of the day is genuinely enough.

Q7. What if I disagree with feedback I get during a paired or group exercise?

A: You're allowed to disagree — the group's read on you is one data point, not a verdict. Note it, sit with it, and decide for yourself whether it rings true. Sometimes disagreement itself is useful information about a blind spot; sometimes the group is just wrong.

Q8. Can I do the worksheets digitally instead of on paper?

A: Yes — the Templates workbook is available as a fillable digital document. Use whichever format you'll actually keep and revisit later.